

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Public Visitor

Status: Draft for internal review

Author: Ryan Schmaltz (ryan@soncea.com)

Last updated: June 28, 2026

Audience: Product, Design, Engineering, Legal, Research, GTM

Contents

[Section 1: Vision & Mission](#)

[Section 2: User Stories & User Journey](#)

[Section 3: Guiding Design Principles](#)

[Section 4: UI / UX Screen Checklist](#)

[Section 5: Functional Requirements](#)

[Section 6: Technical Requirements / Non-Functional Requirements](#)

[Section 7: Success Criteria for Public Visitors](#)

[Section 8: Key Data & Analytics](#)

[Section 9: Error States](#)

[Section 10: Legal Requirements](#)

[Appendix A: Sonocea is Different than _____](#)

Link to full mobile app PRD:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1ekuoHbj_DNcH6uCe4iwHibPnO_oOj4kq2qcdw1y-7vo/edit?usp=sharing

Section 1: Vision & Mission

Vision

Create a welcoming, low-friction first-time experience that allows anyone who downloads the Sonocea app to understand and briefly experience the product, regardless of whether they have organizational access. The experience should feel premium, scientific, and credible while protecting licensed content, customer-specific protocols, and organization-only functionality.

Mission

Give unverified users a meaningful public experience: education, a short non-clinical listening sample, self-reflection, and a clear path to request access or sign in through an organization.

Objectives

- Support the current B2B2C model by making the app useful to people who arrive before their organization has verified them.
- Support future B2B and B2C expansion by collecting light demand signals and validating which public experiences create trust and engagement.
- Avoid positioning Sonocea as a generic wellness, meditation, music therapy, binaural beats, or music.
- For Unverified Users:
 - Convert curiosity into awareness and trust,
 - A short listening experience, information and resources
 - Gather preliminary user and market data that will inform a future B2C expansion
 - Provide a clear path toward organizational or future consumer access

Business Justification:

Sonocea is being discovered through conferences, clinicians, healthcare organizations, social media, podcasts, word of mouth, and the App Store.

Rather than presenting users with an "access denied" experience, the app should immediately demonstrate Sonocea's value through a curated public experience while protecting licensed content and organization-specific functionality.

This approach strengthens Sonocea's credibility as a science-based platform, supports App Store distribution as a consumer-facing application, creates opportunities for prospective users to request organizational access, and establishes a foundation for a future direct-to-consumer offering. The MVP should prioritize simplicity by leveraging existing authentication, static educational content, a single curated listening session, and a lightweight access request flow.

Section 2: User Stories & User Journey

Definitions of User Roles:

“Public Visitor”

An individual who downloaded and is interested in exploring, trying, accessing the Sonocea app without either a direct invitation from the Sonocea team or an invitation from an organization affiliate of Sonocea.

“Invited Participant”

An individual who downloaded the Sonocea App who has received an invitation either directly from Sonocea or an organization affiliate but has not yet signed-up, signed-in or has been otherwise authenticated.

User Stories:

ID	Role	Story
PV-01	Public Visitor	As a public visitor, I want to understand what Sonocea is so that I know whether it is relevant to me.
PV-02	Public Visitor	As a public visitor, I want to try a short listening sample, so that I can feel the nature of the experience without receiving restricted protocol content.
PV-03	Public Visitor	As a public visitor, I want to learn the science in simple language, so that I understand how structured sound is different from generic relaxation audio.
PV-04	Public Visitor	As a public visitor, I want to request access, further information or to join the mailing list.
PV-05	Public Visitor	As a public visitor, I want to provide information about myself to inform Sonocea how to best engage with me and to align products to my specific needs or interests.
IP-01	Invited Participant	As an invited participant, I want to familiarize myself with Sonocea and how Sonocea can benefit me.
IP-02	Invited Participant	As an invited participant, I want to activate my account through my organization, affiliation or direct invitation from Sonocea staff.

SA-01	Sonocea Admin	As a Sonocea admin, I want public usage and access-request data, so that the team can evaluate demand and prioritize follow-up.
-------	---------------	---

User Journey:

Layer 0: Get Started

User selects: "Discover Sonocea", "Accept Invitation", "Login"

"Discover Sonocea" leads to Layer

"Accept Invitation" leads to brief intro then sign-up flow

"Login" leads to authentication to member area specific to the organization that the user is affiliated with.

Layer 1: Discover Sonocea

How is your nervous system today? Simple sliders:

Stress Level

Your Energy Level

Focus

Restfulness

Put on your headphones notification, be in a quiet place free of distractions

Take a 5-minute Nervous System Reset

How did that feel? (remeasure)

Stress Level

Your Energy Level

Focus

Restfulness

Layer 2: How Sonocea Works / Explore The Science

What is the autonomic nervous system?

Why does sound influence physiology?

What is Sonic Augmentation Technology™?

What is Sonostasis®?

Use Cases

Why is HRV important?

Current clinical research

How this is different from _____
Our Story

Layer 3: Register Interest

Information collection (i.e. "stay in the loop")

vs. light individual-level sign-up (To be discussed)

Layer 4: Returning Public Visitor (unauthenticated vs light sign-up)

Daily Reset Experience: How is Your Nervous System Today & Short Listening Session.

The Science: Learn about the autonomic nervous system.

The Research: Clinical studies, biomarkers, and institutional partners.

Applications: Healthcare, performance, recovery, pregnancy, palliative care, and other use cases described on the site.

How Sonocea is Different: See Appendix A

Our Story: Stephen Porges, Anthony Gorry, and how Sonocea emerged from decades of neuroscience research.

Persistent Navigation Model after First-Time-UX for Public Visitors:

- Home
- Daily Reset*
- Science
- Research
- Applications
- Our Story
- Request Access

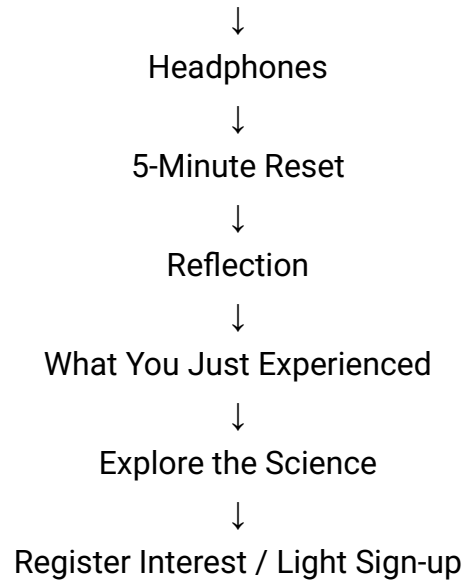
**Note: Sonocea may wish to do additional sound drops from time to time as a way to engage Public Visitors who have registered interest (Layer 3). Initially Sonocea would notify registered Public visitors via their email, however in a later version we may wish to use push notifications.*

Guiding Golden Route for first time user experience - Public Visitor:

Welcome



Check-In with yourself



Section 3: Guiding Design Principles

1. Experience before explanation.
2. Calm, premium, and scientifically credible.
3. Minimize friction.
4. Protect licensed protocols.
5. Every screen should move the user toward trust.

Section 4: UI / UX Screen Checklist (draft / WIP)

- ☐ Splash
- ☐ Get Started
- ☐ Check-In
- ☐ Headphone Prompt
- ☐ Listening Session
- ☐ Reflection
- ☐ How Sonocea Works
- ☐ Science Home
- ☐ Topic Detail
- ☐ Applications
- ☐ Our Story
- ☐ Request Access
- ☐ Login

- ☐ Invitation
- ☐ Returning User Home

Section 5: Functional Requirements

- FR-001 Public visitors may access Discover Sonocea without authentication.
- FR-002 Users may complete one curated listening session.
- FR-003 No licensed protocols are accessible to unauthenticated users.
- FR-004 Users may browse educational content without signing in.
- FR-005 Users may submit an access request for themselves or their organization.
- FR-006 Returning visitors resume at Public Home but must lightly authenticate to replay the 5-minute nervous system reset.
- FR-007 Invitation and Login bypass the public experience after authentication.

Section 6: Technical Requirements / Non-Functional Requirements

[See Mobile App v.1 PRD](#)

Section 7: Success Criteria for Public Visitors

- 60%+ of public visitors complete the 5-minute experience.
- 40%+ explore at least one science page.
- 20%+ submit an access request or join updates.
- 30%+ return within 7 days.
- Average App Store rating ≥ 4.5

Section 8: Key Data & Analytics

- App Installed
- iOS or Android + OS version
- Geo-location
- Public Visitor - User Actions:
 - Discover Selected
 - Invitation Selected
 - Login Selected
 - Check-In Started
 - 5-minute Session Started
 - 5-minute Session Completed

- Reflection Submitted
- Science Article Viewed
- Request Access Submitted
- Return Visit
- Return Visit Frequency

Section 9: Error States

- No internet
- Audio unavailable
- Session interrupted
- Login failure ([see v.1 PRD](#))
- Invitation expired ([see v.1 PRD](#))
- Others?

Section 10: Legal Requirements

- Include a simple privacy statement for Public Visitors (GDPR compliant)
- [See v.1 PRD](#)

Section 11: Future Versions under Exploration

To be determined and prioritized at a future date

Future versions related to Public Visitors may advance B2C ambitions in the following ways:

- Push notifications to Public Visitors (ex. New Session drops, Protocol reminders)
- B2C related features:
 - More advanced account sign-up & authentication
 - Multiple Sessions for listening
 - Listening Protocols with multiple Sessions per protocol
- In-app purchases / Subscription Purchase
- Account Management Features
- Community of Clinicians
- Personalized Listening Protocols

Appendix A: How Sonocea is Different than ____.

Lean into and proactively address common misconceptions about Sonocea to facilitate marketing and clinical alignment.

Generic Playlists	[to be updated]
Relaxation Audio	[to be updated]
Meditation Audio	[to be updated]
Sound Baths	[to be updated]
Binaural Beats	[to be updated]
White Noise	[to be updated]
Sleep Audio	[to be updated]
Wellness Apps	[to be updated]